

Ben Morrell

Software Alliances Leader — ISV Partnerships · EMEA

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UK / Australian Citizen · Spain Digital Nomad Visa · Available as an independent contractor through my own business entity

Dear Canonical Software Alliances team,

The job your posting describes, persuading software companies to build on your platform and then making the joint product sell, is the one I have done most often. At Watching That, a London streaming-data company, I signed **Brightcove** as an integration partner after the company had chased them for three to four years. Brightcove was the larger platform, and the work was getting their product team to put our data into their roadmap, then building the joint go-to-market behind it. At Brightcove itself, as VP for Asia, I recruited **15+ ISV and agency partners** into an ecosystem that grew to source **35% of regional pipeline** while the region went from ~\$4M to ~\$11.5M ARR.

Your must-haves ask for system architecture alongside business development, and that pairing is where I am unusual. I trained as an engineer (MEng Electronic Engineering) and started in system design: sole architect of Nine Network's all-IP broadcast system for the Beijing 2008 Olympics, then solutions engineering inside a systems integrator, then presales across twelve Asian countries writing reference architectures. I still build. My consultancy runs on software I wrote: Next.js on Vercel, LLM applications and a production MCP server. When a partner's engineering lead asks what an integration should actually do, I can hold that conversation myself.

The alliance I am proudest of was the hardest to close. For an Australian IoT company with no European channel I went after Roche Diagnostics cold and negotiated an exclusive global reseller agreement: seven figures, three-year minimum, an \$80B counterparty. It stalled in Roche's legal and compliance machinery and got signed because I kept the sponsors inside Roche visible and answered every compliance question fast, while holding the founder firm on exclusivity and the minimum commitment. That channel produced NHS sales and a ten-year OLVG contract.

I work fully remote from Valencia, inside EMEA hours, and I ran a business across borders and time zones for four and a half years from a 40-foot boat, so remote-first is simply how I work. The travel and the in-person sprints are fine.

I would welcome 20 minutes on which EMEA alliance accounts matter most this year and where the roadmap conversations are stuck.

Best regards,
Ben Morrell